

PRIMARY 4 NIGERIAN HISTORY SCHEME OF WORK

FIRST TERM

Week	Topic	Content
1	Geography and Environment I	Location of Nigeria in Africa and the world; Nigeria's neighbors; Physical features - mountains, rivers, plateaus; Climate and vegetation zones
2	Geography and Environment II	Map reading basics; Major rivers in Nigeria - Niger, Benue, Cross River; Landforms and their importance; Natural resources in Nigeria
3	Nigerian Peoples I	Major ethnic groups in Nigeria - Hausa, Igbo, Yoruba; Location and traditional occupations; Simple greetings in different languages; Cultural diversity
4	Nigerian Peoples II	Other ethnic groups in Nigeria - Fulani, Ijaw, Kanuri, Tiv, Ibibio; Traditional dressing and food; Respect for all ethnic groups; Unity in diversity
5	MIDTERM EXAMINATION	Assessment of topics covered in weeks 1-4
6	MIDTERM BREAK	Rest and relaxation period
7	Nigerian Peoples III	Traditional occupations - farming, fishing, trading, craft-making; Market systems in different communities; Traditional economic activities; Barter trade
8	Traditional Rulers and Governance	Traditional rulers in Nigeria - Obas, Emirs, Chiefs; The role of traditional rulers; Respect for authority; Simple palace structures
9	Family and Community Living	The Nigerian family structure; Roles in the family; Community leaders; Living together peacefully; Helping in the community
10	Our Cultural Heritage	Traditional festivals in Nigeria; Why we celebrate festivals; Traditional music and dance; Preserving our culture

11	REVISION	Review of all topics covered; Practice exercises; Question and answer sessions
12	EXAMINATION	End of term assessment
13	CLOSING	Report card distribution; Vacation assignment



PRIMARY 4 NIGERIAN HISTORY LESSON NOTES

FIRST TERM

WEEK 1: GEOGRAPHY AND ENVIRONMENT I

OBJECTIVES By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

- Describe the location of Nigeria in Africa.
- List the four neighboring countries of Nigeria.
- Identify three major physical features of Nigeria (rivers, mountains).
- Mention the two main seasons in Nigeria.

CONTENT

Location of Nigeria

Nigeria is a country located on the continent of Africa. If you look at a map of the world, find Africa. Nigeria is in the western part of Africa, which we call West Africa. It is often called the “Giant of Africa” because it has more people than any other African country. Nigeria is close to an imaginary line called the Equator, which makes our weather warm or hot most of the time.



Nigeria's Neighbors (Border Countries)

Countries that share a land border with Nigeria are called its neighbors. Nigeria has four neighbor countries. You can remember them like the four sides of a square:

- To the North: Niger Republic.
- To the North-East: Chad.
- To the East: Cameroon.
- To the West: Benin Republic.
- To the South: Nigeria does not have a country neighbor to the south. Instead, it has a large body of water called the Atlantic Ocean. This is Nigeria's coastline.



Physical Features (The Shape of Our Land)

Nigeria is not flat everywhere. It has different landforms that make it beautiful:

- **Rivers:** The two biggest and most important rivers are River Niger and River Benue. They meet at a city called Lokoja. This meeting point is called a confluence. It looks like the letter Y on the map.
- **Highlands (Mountains and Plateaus):** These are high areas of land. The Jos Plateau is a large flat highland. It is cooler than other parts of Nigeria. The Obudu Plateau has mountains and is very beautiful.
- **Vegetation:** This means the type of plants that grow in an area. Forests in the South have many tall trees (like mahogany, iroko). Savannah in the North has more grass and shorter trees.

Climate (Our Seasons) Climate is the pattern of weather a place has over a long time. Nigeria has two main seasons:

- **The Dry Season:** This season is hot and sunny with little or no rain. A special wind called the Harmattan blows during this time, bringing dust from the Sahara Desert. The air becomes dry and hazy.
- **The Rainy Season:** This season has frequent rain. It is cooler and plants grow very well. Farmers love this season for planting crops.

EVALUATION

- Nigeria is in which region of Africa? (West Africa / East Africa).
- Name one country that shares a border with Nigeria to the west.
- What large body of water is found to the south of Nigeria?
- Which two major rivers meet at Lokoja?
- During which season do we experience the Harmattan wind? (Dry Season / Rainy Season).

ASSIGNMENT

- (Drawing): Draw the simple outline of Nigeria. Label the Atlantic Ocean to the south.
- (Oral & Written): Ask an elder at home: “Which season is better for farming, dry or rainy? Why?” Write down their one-sentence answer.

- (Practical): Look outside for one week. Is it the dry or rainy season now? Draw a picture of the sky today.
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WEEK 2: GEOGRAPHY AND ENVIRONMENT II

OBJECTIVES By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

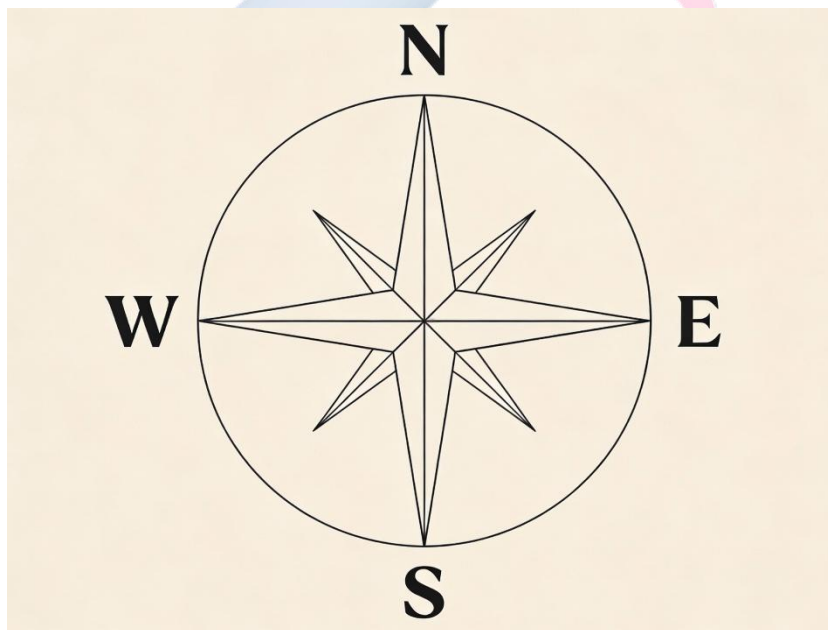
- Explain what a map is.
- Identify the “Y” shape on the map of Nigeria (River Niger and Benue).
- List three natural resources found in Nigeria.
- State the importance of rivers to people.

CONTENT

Map Reading Basics

A map is a flat drawing of a place (like a town, state, or country) on paper. It helps us find where things are without traveling there. To read a map, we use cardinal points. **Cardinal Points:**

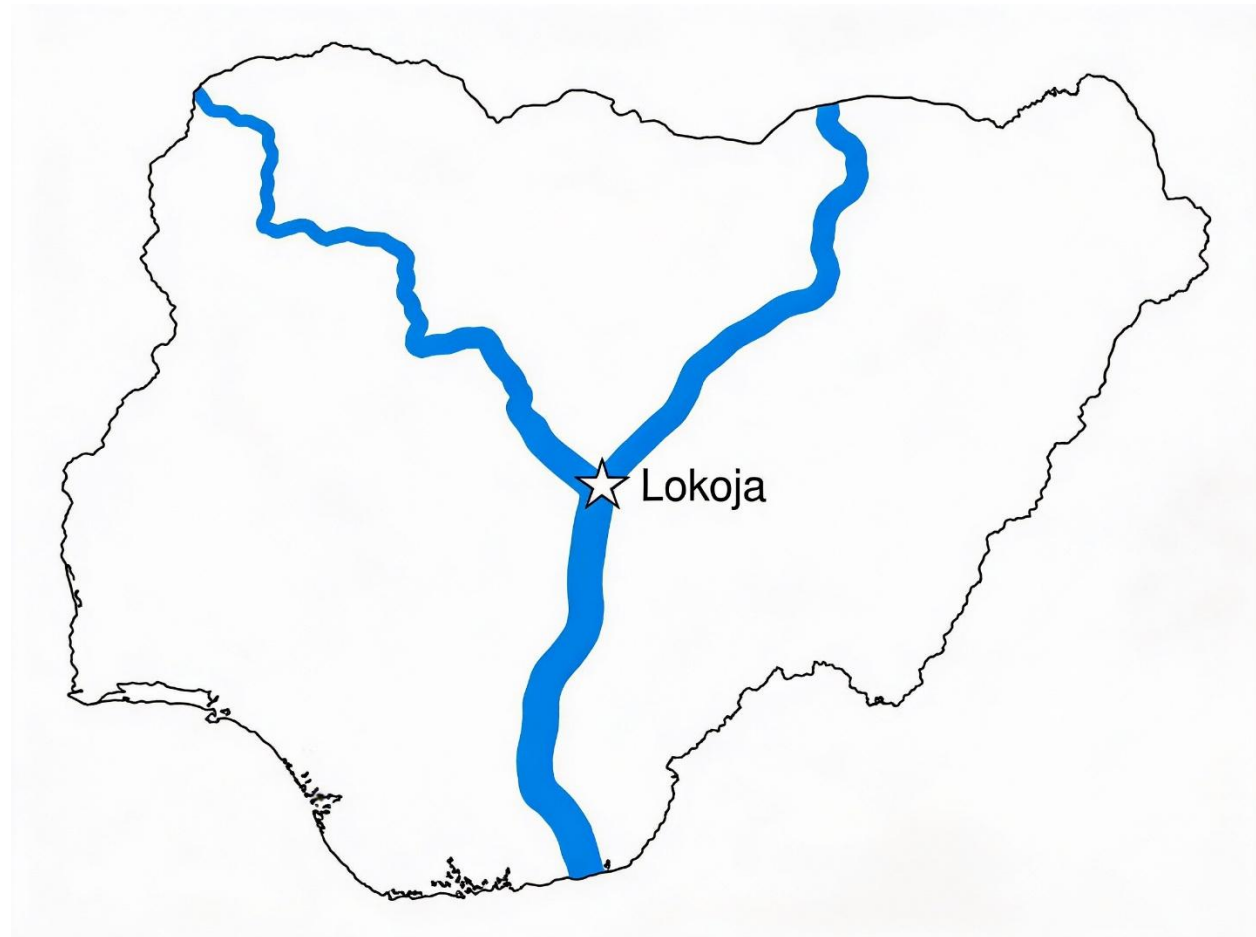
These are the main directions: North (N), South (S), East (E), West (W). On most maps, North is at the top.



Major Rivers: The Famous ‘Y’ Shape

Look at a map of Nigeria. You will see two big blue lines that look like the letter Y. This is not a real letter; it shows our two biggest rivers! River Niger flows from the North-West. River Benue

flows from the North-East. They join together at Lokoja (in Kogi State) to form one big river that flows south to the ocean.



Why Are Rivers Important to People?

Rivers are very useful. People who live near rivers use them for:

- **Water:** For drinking (after treatment), cooking, bathing, and washing clothes.
- **Farming:** Farmers use river water to water their crops when there is no rain. This is called irrigation.
- **Food:** Fishermen catch fish, crabs, and prawns from rivers.
- **Transport:** People use boats, canoes, and ferries to travel and move goods on rivers.

Natural Resources (Gifts from Our Land) Nigeria is rich in natural resources. These are valuable things found in nature that we can use.

Resource	Where it is Found	What we use it for
Crude Oil (Petroleum)	Niger Delta (e.g., Rivers, Bayelsa)	To make fuel (petrol, diesel), plastics, kerosene.
Coal	Enugu State	Was used for trains and power; also for cooking.
Tin & Columbite	Jos Plateau (Plateau State)	Used in making electronics and metal products.
Cocoa	South-West (Ondo, Ogun)	Used to make chocolate and drinks.
Timber (Wood)	Southern Forests	Used to build houses, make furniture and paper.

EVALUATION

- What do the two blue lines forming a ‘Y’ on Nigeria’s map represent? (Two major rivers).
- If you are facing the rising sun, which cardinal direction are you facing? (East).
- Give two reasons why a farmer would want to live near a river.
- Which natural resource is known as “black gold” and found in the Niger Delta? (Crude Oil).
- What do we get from cocoa beans? (Chocolate).

ASSIGNMENT

- (Drawing): On a blank paper, draw a big letter Y. Label the top-left branch “River Niger,” the top-right branch “River Benue,” and the bottom stem “They flow to the ocean.”
- (Written): List three things people in your community use water for every day.
- (Oral & Research): Ask: “What is one important farm product or mineral from our state?” Share the answer in class.

WEEK 3: NIGERIAN PEOPLES I (MAJOR ETHNIC GROUPS)

OBJECTIVES By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

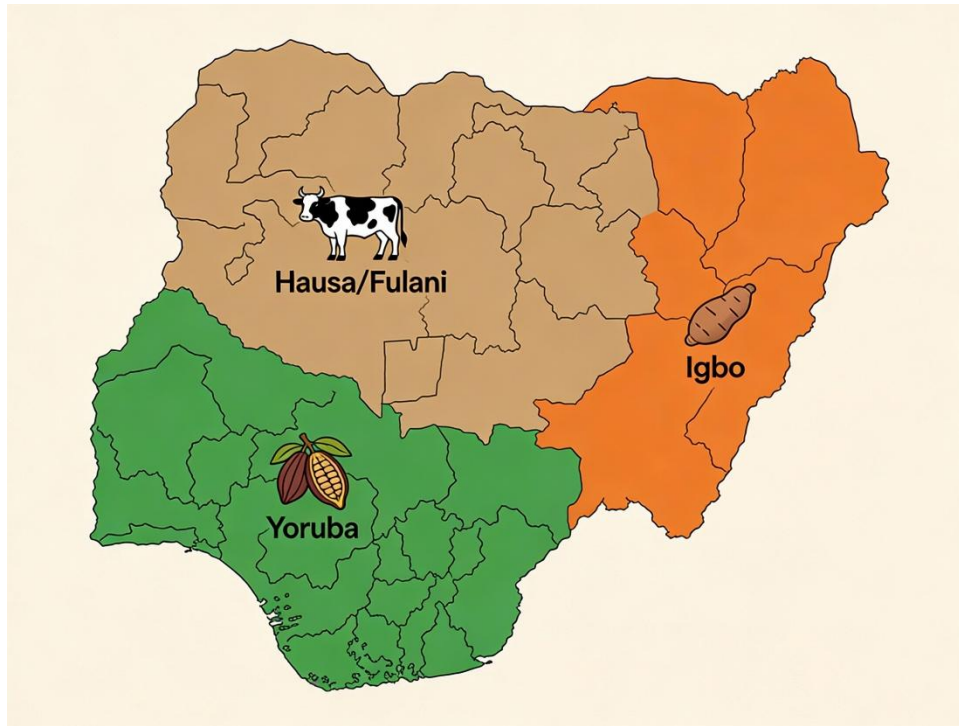
- List the three major ethnic groups in Nigeria.
- Locate where these groups mainly live (North, East, West).
- Mention the traditional occupation of each group.
- Say a simple greeting in Hausa, Igbo, and Yoruba.

CONTENT

Major Ethnic Groups

Nigeria has over 250 different ethnic groups (tribes). The three largest groups are:

Group	Main Region in Nigeria	Traditional Occupation	Common Greeting
Hausa/Fulani	Northern Nigeria (e.g., Kano, Sokoto)	Farming (onions, tomatoes, grains) and Cattle rearing (cows, goats).	“Sannu” (Hello)
Yoruba	South-Western Nigeria (e.g., Lagos, Oyo, Osun)	Farming (cocoa, yam), Trading, and Craft-making (like Adire cloth).	“Ẹ ká àárọ̀” (Good morning)
Igbo	South-Eastern Nigeria (e.g., Anambra, Imo, Abia)	Trading (they are famous businesspeople), Farming (yam, cassava, palm oil).	“Kedụ” (How are you?)



More About Their Lives:

- **Hausa/Fulani:** Many live in the dry savannah. The Fulani people are known for moving with their cattle to find grass and water (this is called nomadic herding).
- **Yoruba:** They have many ancient kingdoms like Oyo and Ife. They are famous for their beads, drums, and festivals.
- **Igbo:** They are very enterprising and travel all over Nigeria and the world to do business. They have a strong tradition of communal work.

Cultural Diversity is Our Strength

We all speak different languages, eat different foods, and wear different clothes, but we are all Nigerians. This variety is called diversity. It makes our country interesting and strong, like a beautiful cloth made from many different colors of thread.

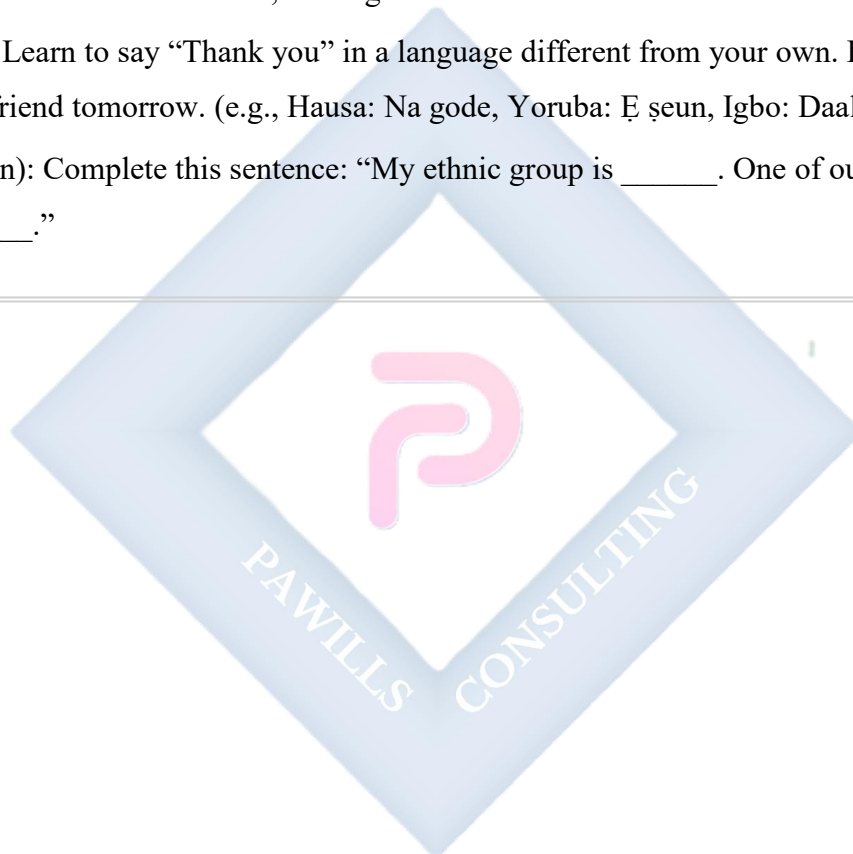
EVALUATION

- What are the three largest ethnic groups in Nigeria?
- Which major group is mostly found in the South-East?

- What is the main occupation of the Fulani people?
- How would you greet a Yoruba elder in the morning?
- True or False: The Igbo people are known mainly as fishermen. (False – they are known as traders and farmers).

ASSIGNMENT

- (Drawing & Labeling): Draw the outline of Nigeria. Write “Hausa/Fulani” in the North, “Yoruba” in the South-West, and “Igbo” in the South-East.
- (Oral): Learn to say “Thank you” in a language different from your own. Practice and say it to a friend tomorrow. (e.g., Hausa: Na gode, Yoruba: E ɣeun, Igbo: Daalụ).
- (Written): Complete this sentence: “My ethnic group is _____. One of our special foods is _____.”



WEEK 4: NIGERIAN PEOPLES II (OTHER ETHNIC GROUPS)

OBJECTIVES By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

- List five other ethnic groups in Nigeria apart from the major three.
- Identify the region where the Ijaw and Kanuri people live.
- Describe the traditional dressing of one ethnic group.
- Explain the importance of unity in diversity.

CONTENT

Other Important Ethnic Groups

Nigeria is like a big family with many children. Besides the three biggest, we have hundreds of other important groups. Here are five:

Ethnic Group	Main Region	What They are Known For
Ijaw	South-South (Niger Delta – Rivers, Bayelsa)	Fishing, swimming, and canoeing. They live close to the water.
Kanuri	North-East (Borno, Yobe)	Rich history, horse riding, and Islamic scholarship.
Tiv	North-Central (Benue, Taraba)	Farming (Benue is called the “Food Basket” of Nigeria).
Efik/Ibibio	South-South (Akwa Ibom, Cross River)	Colorful festivals (Ekpe), delicious soups (Edikang Ikong), and hospitality.
Edo (Bini)	South-South (Edo State)	Ancient Benin Kingdom, bronze art, and their king, the Oba.

A Peek at Traditional Dressing

Traditional clothes show our culture and are worn during festivals, weddings, and important events.

- **Hausa/Fulani:** Men wear a big, flowing gown called Babanriga or Babban Riga with a cap (Hula). Women wear wrappers and blouses with a head tie (Gyale).
- **Yoruba:** Men wear Agbada (a big flowing robe) with a cap (Fila). Women wear Iro (wrapper), Buba (blouse), and Gele (head tie).
- **Igbo:** Men wear Isi Agu (a lion's head patterned top) with a red cap (Okpu Agu) and a walking stick. Women wear blouses and beautiful wrappers with a head tie.
- **Ijaw:** Men wear a shirt called Etibo and a hat.



Unity in Diversity

This means we stay together and are strong even though we are different. We should:

- **Respect** other people's languages and customs.
- **Learn** about other cultures by eating their food or watching their dances.
- **Be friendly** to everyone, no matter their tribe. A united Nigeria is like a strong bundle of sticks – hard to break!

EVALUATION

- Name two ethnic groups found in the South-South region.
- The Tiv people are famous for being great _____. (Farmers / Fishermen).
- What is the name of the traditional shirt worn by Ijaw men?
- True or False: It is good to make fun of someone's traditional attire. (False).
- What does "Unity in Diversity" mean for Nigeria? (Staying together despite our differences).

ASSIGNMENT

- (Drawing): Draw a person wearing the traditional cap from your own ethnic group or one you like. Color it.
- (Oral & Research): Ask an elder at home: "What is the name of a popular dish from another tribe in Nigeria?" Share the name in class.
- (Written): Write one sentence about how you can show respect to a classmate from a different tribe.

WEEK 5: MID-TERM EXAMINATION

OBJECTIVES By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

- Answer questions covering topics from Week 1 to Week 4.

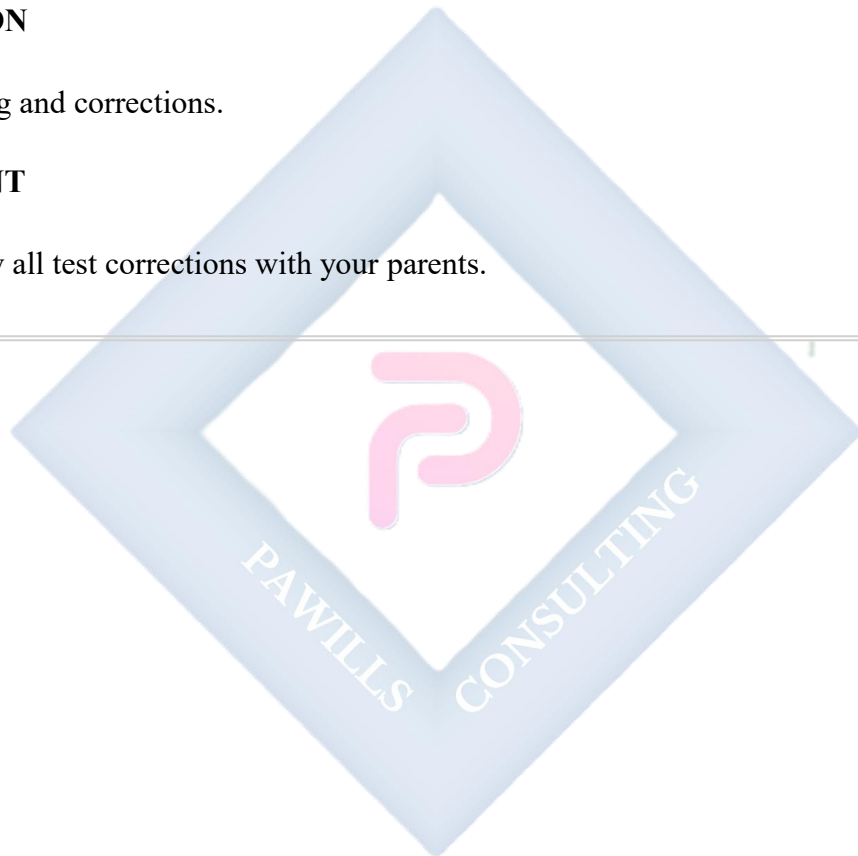
CONTENT Assessment: The teacher will administer a written test covering Geography (Map, Rivers, Seasons, Resources) and Nigerian Peoples (Major & Minor tribes, Occupations, Dressing, Unity).

EVALUATION

- Grading and corrections.

ASSIGNMENT

- Review all test corrections with your parents.



WEEK 6: MID-TERM BREAK



WEEK 7: NIGERIAN PEOPLES III (TRADITIONAL OCCUPATIONS)

OBJECTIVES By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

- List four traditional occupations in Nigeria.
- Explain what Barter Trade means.
- Identify the connection between environment and occupation (e.g., River areas = Fishing).
- Mention items produced by craftsmen.

CONTENT

Traditional Occupations (Jobs of the Past)

Long ago, before offices and factories, Nigerians worked in jobs that used the resources around them. Your job often depended on where you lived.

Occupation	Where it was Common	What They Did/Produced
Farming	All over Nigeria, especially rural areas.	Grew food like yam, cassava, maize, vegetables.
Fishing	Coastal areas (e.g., Ijaw, Ilaje) & near rivers/lakes.	Caught fish, shrimp, crayfish using nets, traps, hooks.
Cattle Rearing	Northern Savannah (Fulani).	Raised cows, goats, sheep for milk, meat, and leather.
Pottery	Areas with good clay soil (e.g., Suleja).	Made clay pots, bowls, water coolers (kongo).
Weaving	Various areas (e.g., Akwete, Iseyin).	Wove cloth (Aso-Oke, Akwete cloth), mats, baskets.
Blacksmithing	Villages with iron ore.	Made tools from iron: hoes, cutlasses, knives, arrows.

Environment Determines Occupation

People are smart! They use what their environment provides.

- Live near a river/ocean? → Become a fisherman.
- Live on fertile land with good rain? → Become a farmer.
- Live in the dry grassland? → Become a cattle rearer.

Trade: How People Got What They Needed Market Day:

Each community had a special day for buying and selling.

Barter Trade: Before there was money (Naira), people exchanged goods directly.

- Example: A farmer with extra yams could go to a fisherman and say, “I will give you two big yams for one big fish.” If the fisherman agreed, they would swap.
- Another Example: A potter could trade a water pot for a farmer’s basket of beans.

EVALUATION

- What traditional job would someone living by the sea in Bayelsa most likely do?
- What does a blacksmith make?
- What is Barter Trade? (Trading goods for other goods without money).
- If you are a weaver, what are you making? (Cloth, mats, baskets).
- True or False: A Fulani man living in the savannah would most likely be a fisherman.
(False – he would be a cattle rearer).

ASSIGNMENT

- (Drawing): Draw and label two tools used by a farmer (e.g., hoe, cutlass).
 - (Practical/Oral): With a friend, pretend to do a barter trade. One has a “calabash” (draw it), the other has “fish” (draw it). What would you trade for?
 - (Written): Complete: “My father/mother is a _____. This job is important because _____.”
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WEEK 8: TRADITIONAL RULERS AND GOVERNANCE

OBJECTIVES By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

- Define traditional rulers.
- Match titles of rulers to their ethnic groups (Oba, Emir, Obi, Obong).
- State two roles of traditional rulers.
- Explain why we must respect authority.

CONTENT

Who are Traditional Rulers?

Traditional rulers are kings and chiefs who are the fathers and cultural leaders of their communities. They are not the same as government officials like the Governor or President. They are custodians of our history and traditions.

Royal Titles in Different Kingdoms

Different ethnic groups have different titles for their kings:

Title	Ethnic Group/Region	Example
Emir	Hausa/Fulani (Northern Kingdoms)	Emir of Kano
Oba	Yoruba (South-West) & Edo (Benin)	Ooni of Ife, Oba of Benin
Obi / Eze	Igbo (South-East)	Obi of Onitsha
Obong	Efik/Ibibio (Calabar)	Obong of Calabar
Tor	Tiv (Benue)	Tor Tiv
Olu	Itsekiri/Warri	Olu of Warri

Picture of Crown/Staff		Title & Group
		
Emir	Oba	Obi

Roles and Duties of Traditional Rulers

- **Peace Makers:** They settle disputes between families or villages so people don't go to court for everything.
- **Culture Keepers:** They preside over traditional festivals, ceremonies, and help preserve our language and customs.
- **Chief Advisers:** They advise the modern government on the needs and feelings of their people.
- **Community Development:** They encourage projects like building schools, markets, or health centers.

Showing Respect for Authority

We respect our traditional rulers because:

- They represent our ancestors and our heritage.
- They work for the peace and progress of their people.
- Respect is shown through greetings like bowing (for boys), curtsying (for girls), or prostrating/kneeling in some cultures when in their presence.

EVALUATION

- What is the title of a traditional ruler in a Yoruba kingdom? (Oba).
- Who is the traditional ruler of the Benin people? (The Oba of Benin).
- Mention one important job of a traditional ruler.
- True or False: An Emir is a traditional ruler in the South-East. (False – North).
- Why should we greet a traditional ruler politely? (To show respect for the throne and our culture).

ASSIGNMENT

- (Research & Writing): Find out and write the name of the traditional ruler (Oba, Eze, Emir, etc.) of your own town or a nearby town.
 - (Drawing): Draw a simple crown or a royal staff (sceptre).
 - (Matching): Draw a line to match the title to the correct group:
 - Emir → Hausa/Fulani
 - Obi → Igbo
 - Oba → Yoruba/Benin
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WEEK 9: FAMILY AND COMMUNITY LIVING

OBJECTIVES By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

- Define family.
- Differentiate between Nuclear and Extended family.
- List the roles of father, mother, and children.
- State two ways to live peacefully in the community.

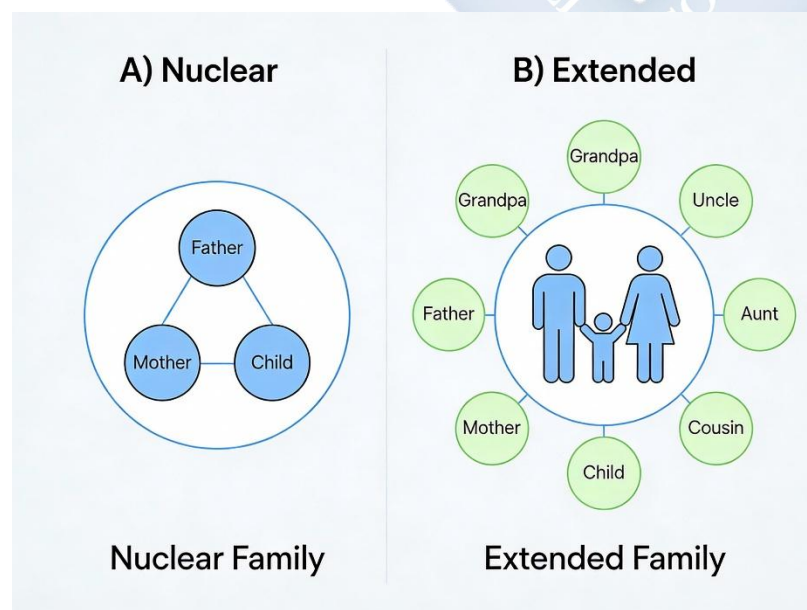
CONTENT

What is a Family?

A family is a group of people related by blood, marriage, or adoption who live together and care for each other. It is the smallest and most important unit of society.

Types of Family Structure in Nigeria

- **Nuclear Family:** This is a small family unit. It consists of Father, Mother, and their Children only. Like a small, neat circle.
- **Extended Family:** This is a large family unit, very common and important in Nigeria. It includes: The Nuclear Family PLUS Grandparents, Uncles, Aunts, Cousins, Nephews, Nieces. Like a big, strong tree with many branches.



Roles and Responsibilities in the Family

Every member has a role to play for the family to be happy and successful.

- **Father:** He is the head of the family. He provides food, shelter, school fees, and protects everyone.
- **Mother:** She manages the home, cooks, cares for the children, and often works to also provide for the family. She teaches good behaviour.
- **Children:** Their main duties are to obey their parents, study hard, and help with household chores suitable for their age (like sweeping, washing plates, fetching water).

Living Peacefully in the Community

A community is made up of many families living together. To have peace:

- **Respect Your Neighbors:** Greet them, do not play loud music too early or late, do not let your waste enter their compound.
- **Be Helpful:** Help a neighbor carrying something heavy. Check on an elderly neighbor.
- **Keep the Environment Clean:** Do not litter. Dispose of waste properly. A clean community is a healthy community.
- **Participate:** Join in community clean-up days or celebrations.

EVALUATION

- Who are the members of a nuclear family?
- Your mother's sister is your _____. (Aunt).
- What is one important duty of a child at home?
- How can you show respect to your neighbor?
- True or False: Throwing rubbish into your neighbor's compound is good. (False).

ASSIGNMENT

- (Drawing): Draw a picture of your own family (who you live with). Write their names or relations (e.g., Dad, Sis, Me).
- (Practical/Written): List two chores you will do at home tonight or tomorrow morning.

- (Oral): Tell the class one rule your family has for living peacefully with neighbors (e.g., “We must greet them every morning.”).
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WEEK 10: OUR CULTURAL HERITAGE

OBJECTIVES By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

- Define cultural heritage.
- List three popular festivals in Nigeria.
- Explain why we celebrate festivals.
- Mention items used in traditional music and dance.

CONTENT

What is Cultural Heritage?

Cultural heritage is the way of life, traditions, festivals, arts, and knowledge passed down from our grandparents and great-grandparents to us. It is what makes us who we are as Nigerians.

Popular Traditional Festivals

Festivals are big, joyful celebrations. Here are some famous ones:

Festival	Ethnic Group/State	What Happens	Why it is Celebrated
Argungu Fishing Festival	Kebbi State (North-West)	Men jump into the river to catch the biggest fish using traditional nets and gourds.	Started as a peace ceremony; now to promote fishing and culture.
New Yam Festival (Iri Ji)	Igbo (South-East)	The first yams are offered to gods/ancestors. There is dancing, masquerades, and feasting on pounded yam.	To thank God/Chukwu for a good harvest.
Eyo Festival	Lagos (Isale Eko)	People dressed as white-robed masquerades (Eyo) parade through the streets.	To honour a deceased important person or an Oba of Lagos.
Durbar	Northern States	A grand parade of horsemen in	To mark the end of

	(Kano, Katsina)	colourful robes, riding decorated horses to salute the Emir.	Ramadan (Sallah) and show loyalty to the Emir.
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Why Do We Celebrate Festivals?

- **Thanksgiving:** To thank God or the gods for life, health, and harvest.
- **Unity:** It brings all members of the community together, including those who live far away.
- **Fun & Entertainment:** It is a time for joy, dancing, eating special foods, and wearing beautiful clothes.
- **Preserving Culture:** It teaches the young people about their history and traditions.

Music and Dance: The Sound of Our Heritage

No festival is complete without music! We use traditional instruments:

- Drums (Talking drum, Gangan, Igba)
- Shakers/Rattles (Sekere, Maracas)
- Gongs (Ogene)
- Flutes (Oja) Each ethnic group has its own special dance steps and rhythms.

EVALUATION

- Name one festival that involves catching fish.
- Which festival is celebrated by the Igbo to mark the harvest of a new crop? (New Yam Festival).
- What color are the robes of the Eyo masquerades? (White).
- Mention one traditional musical instrument.
- Why is it important for communities to celebrate festivals? (To unite people and preserve culture).

ASSIGNMENT

- (Oral Research): Ask your parents or an elder: “What is one important festival celebrated in our hometown or state?” Tell the class its name.

- (Drawing): Draw a traditional drum. You can decorate it with patterns.
 - (Written): Imagine you are at the Durbar festival. Write one sentence about what you would see: “I can see many horses and _____.”
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WEEK 11: REVISION

OBJECTIVES By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

- Recall key concepts taught from Week 1 to Week 10.
- Answer questions on Geography, People, Rulers, and Culture.

CONTENT Comprehensive Review

- **Geography:** Where is Nigeria? Its neighbors, rivers ('Y' shape), seasons, and natural resources.
- **People:** The three major groups (Hausa/Fulani, Yoruba, Igbo) and other groups (Ijaw, Kanuri, Tiv, etc.). Their occupations and traditional attire.
- **Economy & Governance:** Traditional jobs, barter trade, roles of traditional rulers (Emir, Oba, Obi).
- **Society & Culture:** Family types, community living, famous festivals (Argungu, New Yam, Eyo, Durbar), and music.

EVALUATION

- Oral quiz and written revision exercises covering the term's work.

ASSIGNMENT

- Study your notes for the end-of-term examination.
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PRIMARY 4 NIGERIAN HISTORY SCHEME OF WORK

SECOND TERM

Week	Topic	Content
1	Early Settlements in Nigeria	How people lived in ancient times; Early settlements and kingdoms; Archaeological sites - Nok, Ife, Benin; Ancient artifacts and their importance
2	The Kingdom of Benin	Location and history of Benin Kingdom; The Oba of Benin; Benin bronze and art; Trade in the ancient Benin Kingdom
3	The Oyo Empire	Location and history of Oyo Empire; The Alaafin of Oyo; Political structure of Oyo; Trade and economy of Oyo Empire
4	Northern Emirates and Kingdoms	The Hausa states - Kano, Katsina, Zaria; The Kanem-Bornu Empire; Traditional leadership in the north; Trans-Saharan trade
5	MIDTERM EXAMINATION	Assessment of topics covered in weeks 1-4
6	MIDTERM BREAK	Rest and relaxation period
7	Coming of Europeans to Nigeria	Early European explorers; Portuguese traders; Reasons for European interest in Nigeria; First contact with coastal communities
8	The Trans-Atlantic Trade	What is trade; Types of goods traded; Effects on Nigerian communities; Why trade is important
9	Missionaries and Education	Coming of missionaries to Nigeria; Introduction of Western education; Early mission schools; Christianity and Islam in Nigeria
10	Transportation in Old Nigeria	Traditional means of transportation; Footpaths and waterways; Trade routes; Evolution of transportation
11	REVISION	Review of all topics covered; Practice exercises; Question and answer sessions
12	EXAMINATION	End of term assessment

13	CLOSING	Report card distribution; Vacation assignment
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PRIMARY 4 NIGERIAN HISTORY LESSON NOTES

SECOND TERM

WEEK 1: EARLY SETTLEMENTS IN NIGERIA

OBJECTIVES By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

- Define early settlements.
- Mention three ancient civilizations in Nigeria (Nok, Ife, Benin).
- Explain what artifacts are.
- State the importance of these ancient sites to our history.

CONTENT

What are Early Settlements?

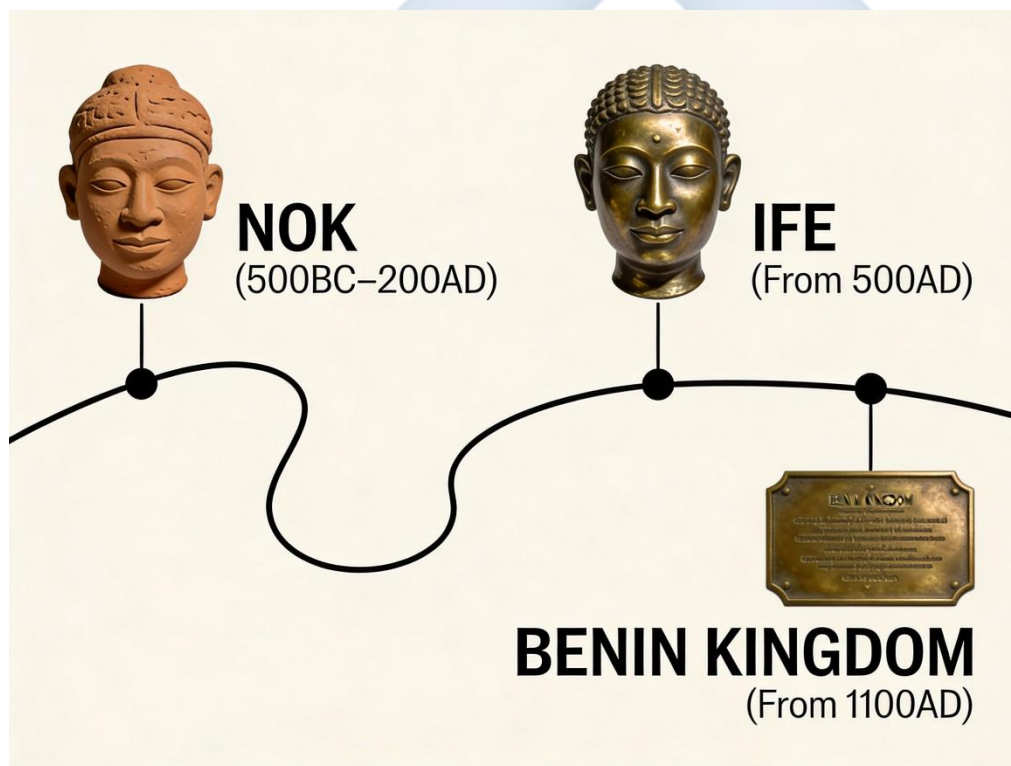
Early settlements were the first places where groups of people decided to live together long ago. They did not have modern houses, cars, or electricity. They lived in caves, rock shelters, or huts made from mud, sticks, and grass. Their main jobs were hunting wild animals and gathering fruits, and later, farming.

Great Ancient Civilizations in Nigeria

Archaeologists (history detectives who dig up old things) have found evidence of three very advanced ancient cultures in Nigeria:

- **The Nok Culture:**
- **Location:** Around Kaduna State (central Nigeria).
- **Famous for:** Terracotta sculptures. These are human and animal figures made from baked clay. Their sculptures have detailed hairstyles and jewelry.
- **Major Achievement:** They were among the first people in West Africa to use iron to make strong tools and weapons.
- **The Ife Civilization:**

- **Location:** Ile-Ife in Osun State (South-West).
- **Famous for:** Extremely beautiful and realistic bronze and terracotta heads. These artworks are some of the finest in Africa.
- **Significance:** The Yoruba people believe Ile-Ife is where the world was created and is the spiritual home of all Yoruba people.
- **The Benin Kingdom:**
- **Location:** Edo State (South-South).
- **Famous for:** Amazing bronze and brass plaques and sculptures. They used these to decorate the Oba's palace and record their history.



What are Artifacts?

Artifacts are objects made or used by people in the past. Examples include:

- Broken pieces of pottery (clay pots)

- Stone tools and iron tools
- Beads, carvings, and sculptures (like the Nok heads) These artifacts are like clues that help us solve the mystery of how our ancestors lived, what they ate, what they wore, and what they believed.

Why are these Ancient Sites Important?

- **They give us pride:** They show that Nigeria had great and clever civilizations long before foreigners came.
- **They teach us history:** They are our own “history books” made of clay and metal.
- **They attract tourists:** People from all over the world come to see them, which brings money to Nigeria.

EVALUATION

- Where were the famous Nok terracotta heads found? (Kaduna area).
- What material did the Ife people use to make their famous sculptures? (Bronze and clay).
- Name one ancient Nigerian civilization.
- What do we call old objects like broken pots and tools found in the ground? (Artifacts).
- Why should we protect places where ancient artifacts are found? (To learn from them and preserve our history).

ASSIGNMENT

- (Drawing): Draw a simple clay pot (an ancient artifact). Decorate it with lines and patterns.
 - (Research): Ask: “Which state in Nigeria is Ile-Ife located in?” (Osun State). Write it down.
 - (Written): Complete this sentence: “Artifacts are important because they tell us about ____.”
-

WEEK 2: THE KINGDOM OF BENIN

OBJECTIVES By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

- Locate the Benin Kingdom on the map of Nigeria.
- State the title of the ruler of Benin.
- Describe the famous art of the Benin Kingdom.
- Mention items traded in the ancient kingdom.

CONTENT

Location and Power

The ancient Benin Kingdom was a very powerful and well-organized kingdom located in the rainforest of what is now Edo State (South-South Nigeria). It was famous for its wealth and its strong army.

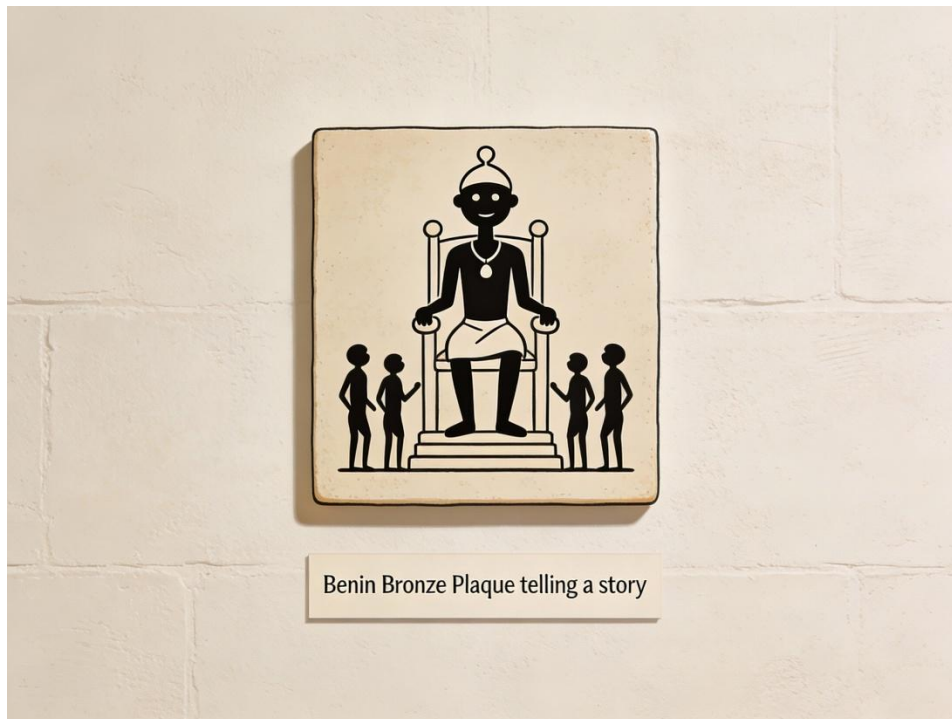
The Oba of Benin

The king of Benin is called the Oba. The Oba was (and still is) a very powerful and respected ruler. He was seen as divine (having a connection to the gods). A very famous Oba was Oba Ewuare the Great, who made the kingdom strong and built big walls around the city.

The Wonder of Benin Art: Bronze and Ivory

The Benin people did not write their history in books. Instead, they told their stories through art.

- **Bronze/Brass Casting:** Benin artists were masters. They made detailed plaques (metal pictures on walls) showing scenes of court life, battles, and the Oba. They also made beautiful heads of past Obas.
- **Ivory Carving:** They carved delicate items from elephant tusks, like bracelets, masks, and ceremonial objects for the Oba.



Trade and Wealth

The Benin Kingdom grew rich through trade, especially with the Portuguese who arrived by sea in the late 1400s.

- **What Benin Sold:** Pepper, palm oil, ivory, and beautiful cloth.
- **What Benin Bought:** Guns, mirrors, coral beads, and cloth from Europe.
- **Their Money:** They used cowrie shells and metal rings called manillas as currency for buying and selling.

EVALUATION

- What is the title of the traditional ruler of the Benin Kingdom?
- In which modern Nigerian state is the Benin Kingdom located?
- What two precious materials did Benin artists use most? (Bronze/Brass and Ivory).
- Name one product that the Benin people sold to European traders.
- What did they use as money before Naira? (Cowrie shells and manillas).

ASSIGNMENT

- (Drawing): Draw the shape of a manilla (an open metal ring used as money).
 - (Research): With help from an elder or a book, find out and write the name of the current Oba of Benin.
 - (Written): List two things that made the ancient Benin Kingdom famous. (e.g., Powerful Obas and Bronze art).
-



WEEK 3: THE OYO EMPIRE

OBJECTIVES By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

- Identify the location of the Oyo Empire.
- State the title of the ruler of Oyo.
- Explain the main strength of the Oyo army.
- Mention the main trade items of the empire.

CONTENT

A Mighty Yoruba Empire

The Oyo Empire was one of the largest and most powerful Yoruba empires. At its peak, it covered parts of modern Oyo, Kwara, Osun states, and even areas in present-day Republic of Benin. Its capital was Oyo-Ile (Old Oyo).

The Alaafin and His Council

The king of the Oyo Empire was called the Alaafin. He was the supreme ruler.

The Oyomesi: The Alaafin did not rule alone. He was advised by a council of seven wise chiefs called the Oyomesi, led by the Bashorun. This council could even remove a bad Alaafin. This shows a system of checks and balances.

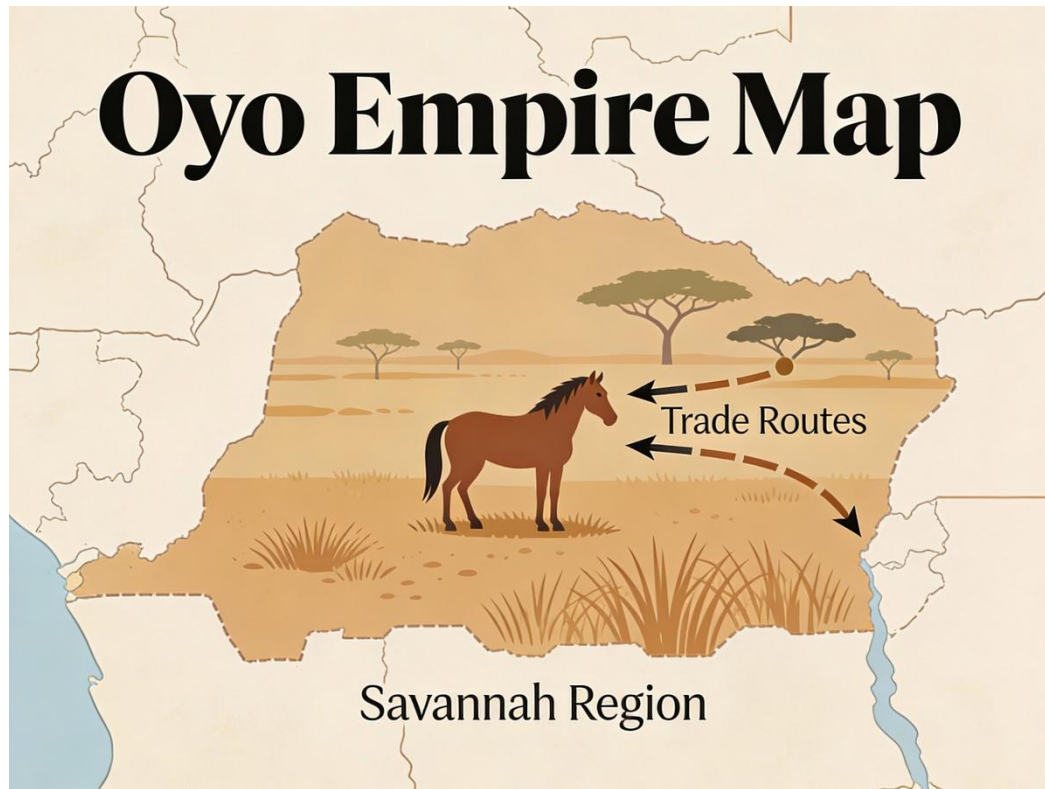
The Secret of Oyo's Power: The Cavalry

Oyo's greatest military strength was its cavalry (soldiers on horseback).

- **Why Horses?** The empire was located in the savannah region (grassland), which was perfect for horses to run. Their enemies in the forest could not use horses easily.
- **Advantage:** Soldiers on horses were very fast, could attack quickly, and were terrifying to foot soldiers. This helped Oyo conquer many other towns.

Trade and Economy

The Oyo Empire controlled important trade routes. They acted as middlemen, trading goods between the forest regions (south) and the savannah regions (north). **Goods Traded:** Kola nuts, cloth, salt, leather goods, and horses.



EVALUATION

- What was the title of the king of the Oyo Empire?
- What animal gave the Oyo army a big advantage in war? (The Horse).
- What was the name of the council of chiefs that advised the Alaaḥin? (Oyomesi).
- Name one state in Nigeria that was part of the old Oyo Empire.
- What valuable nut did the Oyo people trade? (Kola nut).

ASSIGNMENT

- (Drawing): Draw a horse. You can draw a simple rider on it if you can.
- (Written): Write down the title of the leader of the Oyomesi council. (The Bashorun).
- (Reasoning): Why do you think horses were not as useful in the thick rainforests of the South? (Because the trees were too dense for them to run easily).



WEEK 4: NORTHERN EMIRATES AND KINGDOMS

OBJECTIVES By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

- List three Hausa states.
- Identify the Kanem-Bornu Empire.
- State the title of traditional rulers in the North.
- Explain the Trans-Saharan Trade.

CONTENT

The Hausa City-States

Long ago, the Hausa people did not have one big kingdom but several powerful, independent city-states. Each had its own ruler (Sarki) and specialty:

- **Kano:** Famous for dyeing cloth (using indigo) and for being a major trading center.
- **Katsina:** A great center of Islamic learning and scholarship.
- **Zaria (Zazzau):** Famous for its brave warrior queen, Queen Amina. She conquered many lands and built strong walls around her city for protection.

The Kanem-Bornu Empire

This was a very large and powerful empire located around Lake Chad (in present-day North-East Nigeria and beyond).

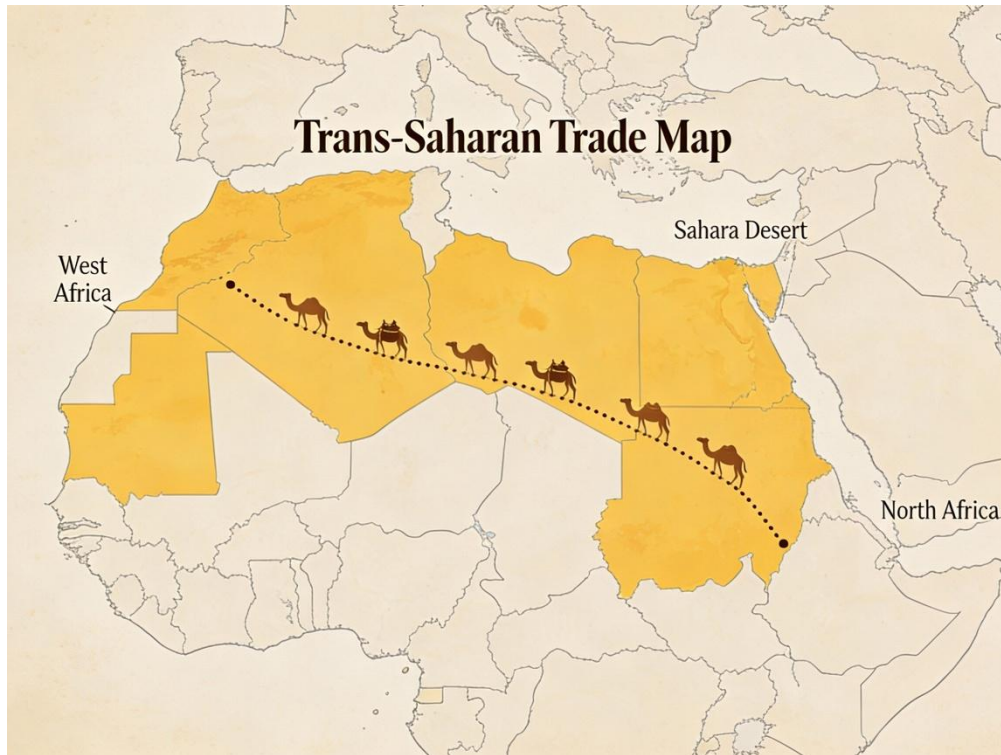
- **Rulers:** Their kings were first called Mai, and later Shehu.
- **Strength:** They had a strong army and were famous for their cavalry (horse riders). They were also great Islamic scholars.

Traditional Leadership Titles

Originally, Hausa rulers were called Sarki. After the Islamic Jihad led by Usman dan Fodio in the early 1800s, these rulers became known as Emirs.

The Amazing Trans-Saharan Trade This was long-distance trade across the Sahara Desert (the big desert in North Africa).

- **The “Ships of the Desert”:** Traders used camels because they could walk for days without water and carry heavy loads.
- **The Trade Route:** Goods moved between West Africa (like Nigeria) and North Africa (like Morocco, Libya).
- **Goods from Nigeria/Sudan:** Gold, ivory, kola nuts, leather, slaves.
- **Goods from North Africa:** Salt, books, swords, silk, horses.



EVALUATION

- Name two of the ancient Hausa city-states.
- Who was the famous warrior queen of Zazzau?
- What title is commonly used for traditional rulers in Northern Nigeria today? (Emir).
- What animal was essential for crossing the Sahara Desert for trade? (Camel).
- Where was the Kanem-Bornu Empire located? (Around Lake Chad).

ASSIGNMENT

- (Drawing): Draw a camel with bags on its back.

- (Research & Writing): Write down the name: Queen Amina of Zaria.
 - (Thinking): Why was salt so valuable that people would trade gold for it across the desert?
(Hint: We need it for our health and to preserve food in hot weather).
-



WEEK 5: MID-TERM EXAMINATION

OBJECTIVES By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

- Attempt questions covering topics from Week 1 to Week 4 correctly.

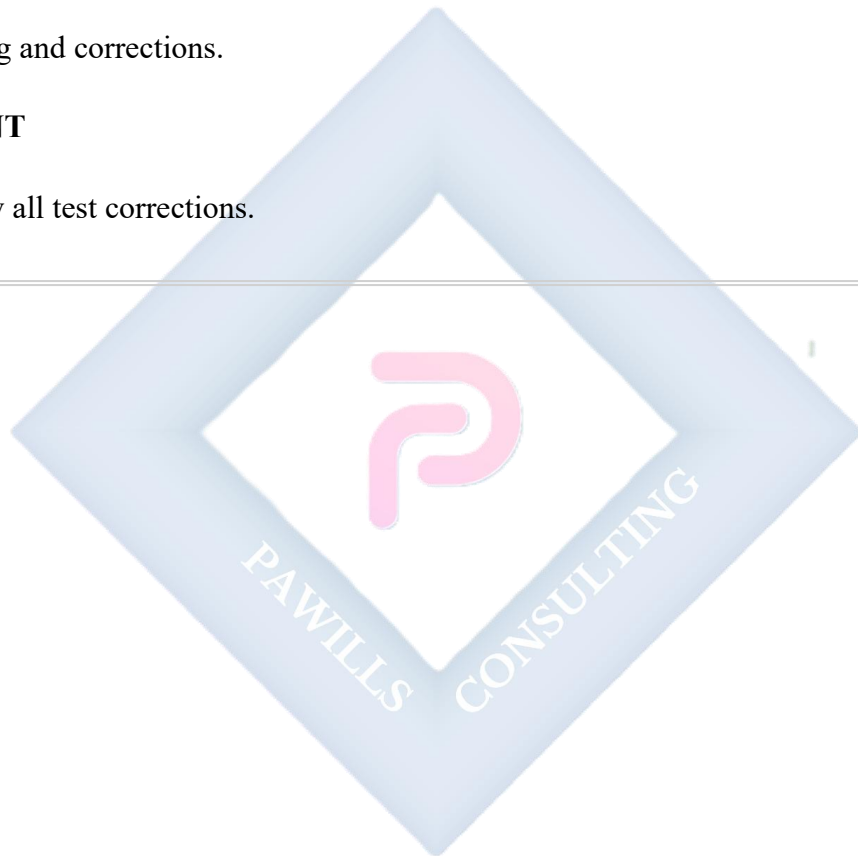
CONTENT Assessment: The teacher will administer a written test covering Early Settlements, Benin Kingdom, Oyo Empire, and Northern Kingdoms.

EVALUATION

- Grading and corrections.

ASSIGNMENT

- Review all test corrections.



WEEK 6: MID-TERM BREAK



WEEK 7: COMING OF EUROPEANS TO NIGERIA

OBJECTIVES By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

- Identify the first Europeans to visit Nigeria.
- State two reasons why Europeans came to Nigeria.
- Mention the famous Scottish explorer (Mungo Park).
- Identify the coastal areas as the point of first contact.

CONTENT

First Contact: The Portuguese

The first Europeans to reach Nigeria by sea were the Portuguese in the 15th century (around the year 1472). They came in large sailing ships and first landed on the coast (the areas near the Atlantic Ocean).

Why Did They Come?

- **Trade:** They had heard about Africa's wealth—gold, ivory, pepper, and spices. They wanted to buy these things directly.
- **Exploration:** They were curious about the world. They wanted to find new sea routes and map new lands.
- **Religion:** Later, missionaries came with the traders to spread Christianity.

Famous Explorer: Mungo Park

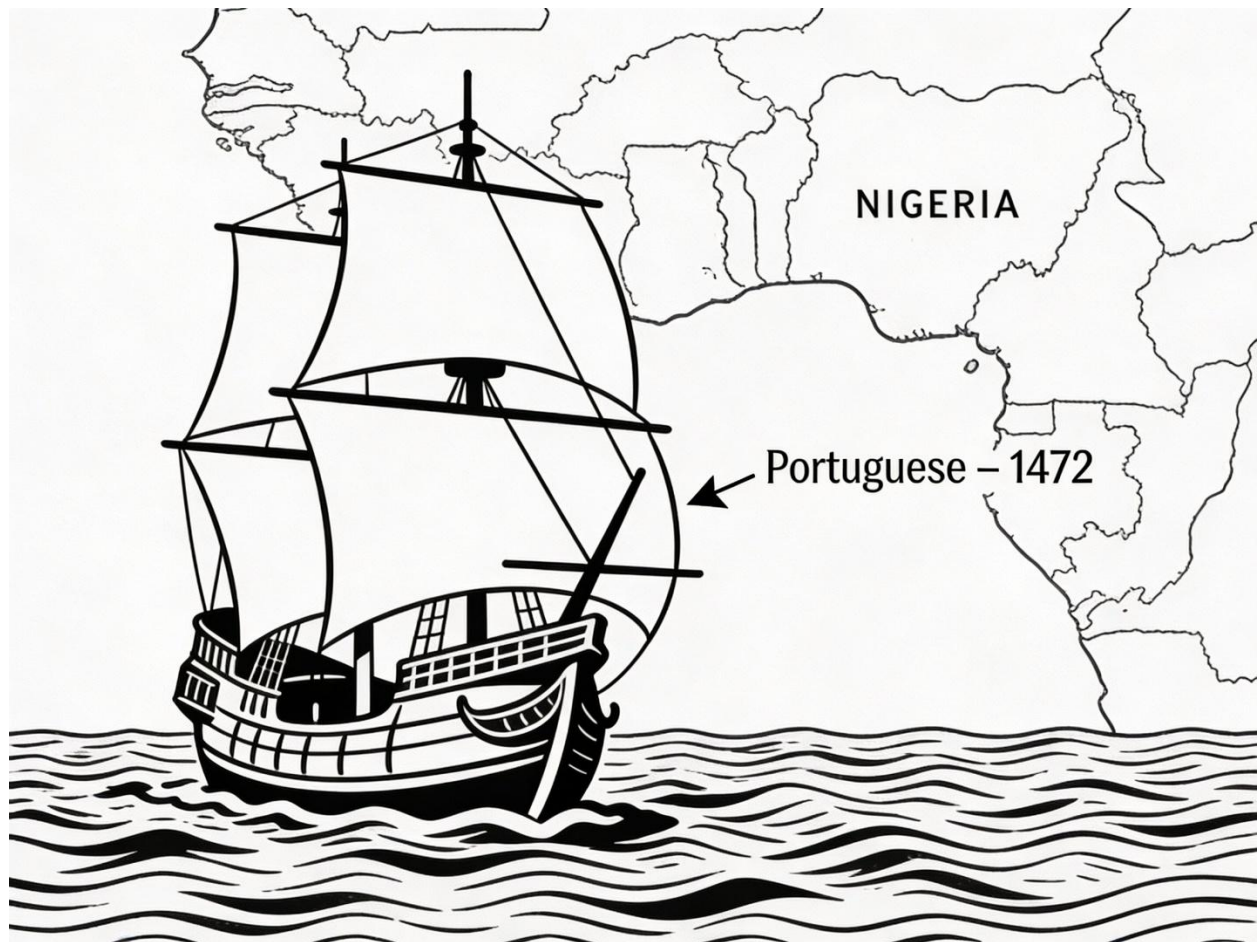
He was a Scottish explorer sent by Britain. His main mission was to explore the River Niger. People in Europe did not know where this long river started or ended. He traveled inland to find out.

Where Did They Land?

The Europeans first made contact with kingdoms along the coast because they came by sea. Important coastal cities included:

- Benin City (via the waterways)

- Lagos
- Calabar
- Bonny The Oba of Benin was one of the first kings to meet the Portuguese. They exchanged gifts and began trading.



EVALUATION

- Which European nation was the first to reach Nigeria by sea?
- How did these first Europeans travel to Nigeria? (By ship/boat).
- What was Mungo Park trying to find out about? (The course of River Niger).
- Give one reason why Europeans wanted to come to Nigeria.
- True or False: The Europeans first arrived in the northern city of Kano. (False – they arrived on the coast in the south).

ASSIGNMENT

- (Drawing): Draw a simple sailing ship on water.
 - (Research): Who was Mungo Park? Write one sentence: “He was an explorer who came to find _____.”
 - (Written): Name one Nigerian city that is on the coast (next to the ocean).
-



WEEK 8: THE TRANS-ATLANTIC TRADE

OBJECTIVES By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

- Define trade.
- List items brought by Europeans to Nigeria.
- List items taken from Nigeria to Europe/Americas.
- State one positive and one negative effect of this trade.

CONTENT

What is Trade?

Trade is the buying and selling of goods and services between people or countries. The Trans-Atlantic Trade was trade across the Atlantic Ocean between West Africa (including Nigeria), Europe, and the Americas.

Goods Exchanged (The Trade Items)

Europeans brought goods that were new or rare in Nigeria. Nigerians sold things that were valuable in Europe.

Goods FROM EUROPE to NIGERIA	Goods FROM NIGERIA to EUROPE/AMERICAS
Guns and Gunpowder	Palm Oil (for making soap and lubricants)
Mirrors	Pepper and Spices
Alcoholic Drinks (Gin)	Ivory (elephant tusks for carving)
Colourful Cloth and Beads	Sadly, Human Beings (Slaves)

The Tragic Slave Trade

The most terrible part of this trade was the buying and selling of people as slaves. Europeans wanted slaves to work on sugar, cotton, and tobacco plantations in the Americas.

- **How it happened:** Some African rulers and traders would capture people from other villages or kingdoms during wars and sell them to European slave dealers at the coast.

- **The Result:** It caused great suffering, broke families apart, and led to wars between communities.

Effects of the Trans-Atlantic Trade

- **Positive Effects:**
 - Some Nigerian kingdoms and traders (like King Jaja of Opobo) became very wealthy.
 - New goods like guns and cloth came into Nigeria.
- **Negative Effects:**
 - It caused insecurity and fear because of slave raids.
 - It led to the loss of millions of strong, young people from Africa.
 - It encouraged wars between communities.

EVALUATION

- What is trade? (Buying and selling).
- Name two items that Europeans brought to Nigeria.
- What valuable oil from Nigeria was used in Europe to make soap? (Palm Oil).
- What was the most harmful item taken from Nigeria during this trade? (Slaves/Human beings).
- Which ocean did ships cross for this trade? (Atlantic Ocean).

ASSIGNMENT

- (Written): Make a two-column table. Label one side “From Europe” and the other “From Nigeria.” List three items in each column.
- (Thinking/Writing): Why do you think some African kings wanted guns from Europe? (For protection or to become more powerful in war).
- (Drawing): Draw a bunch of palm fruits, which are used to make palm oil.

WEEK 9: MISSIONARIES AND EDUCATION

OBJECTIVES By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

- Define a missionary.
- Mention the name of a famous missionary (Mary Slessor/Ajayi Crowther).
- Explain how Western education started in Nigeria.
- State the benefits of early mission schools.

CONTENT

Who are Missionaries?

Missionaries are people who travel to other lands to teach their religion and to help people. Christian missionaries came to Nigeria mainly from Europe.

Heroes of Change: Famous Missionaries

- **Mary Slessor:** A Scottish missionary who lived in Calabar. She is famous for stopping the killing of twins. In those days, some people believed twins were a curse. Mary Slessor rescued twin babies and cared for them, teaching people that twins are a blessing.
- **Bishop Samuel Ajayi Crowther:** He was a Nigerian who was captured as a slave but freed. He became the first African Anglican Bishop. His great work was translating the Bible into the Yoruba language, so people could read it in their own tongue.

The Beginning of Western Schools

The missionaries built the first formal schools in Nigeria. Why? Their main goal was to teach people to read the Bible. The first primary school in Nigeria was built in Badagry, Lagos State, in 1843. The schools taught the “Three Rs”:

- Reading
- Writing
- Arithmetic (Mathematics)

Two Major Religions in Nigeria

- **Islam** came to Northern Nigeria first, hundreds of years earlier, through Trans-Saharan trade with North Africa.
- **Christianity** came to Southern Nigeria later, through European missionaries who came by sea.

Benefits of Mission Schools

- They introduced literacy (the ability to read and write) to many Nigerians.
- They trained clerks, interpreters, and teachers who helped in the new colonial government.
- They built hospitals and fought against some harmful traditional practices.

EVALUATION

- Which missionary worked in Calabar to save twins?
- What did missionaries build to teach people how to read? (Schools).
- Who translated the Bible into the Yoruba language?
- Where was the first primary school in Nigeria built? (Badagry).
- What were the “Three Rs” taught in early mission schools?

ASSIGNMENT

- (Written): Write one sentence about why Mary Slessor is remembered. (e.g., “She saved twin babies.”)
 - (Oral History): Ask your grandparents or an elder if they or anyone in the family attended a mission school. Share what you learn.
 - (Written): What are the “Three Rs”? Write them out.
-

WEEK 10: TRANSPORTATION IN OLD NIGERIA

OBJECTIVES By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

- Identify traditional means of transportation on land and water.
- Mention animals used for transport in the past.
- Describe “Head Portage.”
- Compare old transportation with modern transportation.

CONTENT

How People Moved Long Ago

Before cars, trains, and airplanes, Nigerians used simple but effective methods to travel and move goods.

Land Transport:

- **Walking (On Foot):** This was the most common. People walked long distances on narrow paths through the bush.
- **Head Portage:** This means carrying heavy loads on the head. Women and men were very skilled at balancing pots, baskets, and bundles this way. It freed their hands.
- **Using Animals (Pack Animals):** In areas where they were available, people used animals to carry loads or ride on.
- **Donkeys:** Used for carrying goods.
- **Horses:** Used for riding, especially by kings, chiefs, and warriors.
- **Camels:** Used in the far north for crossing the dry desert.

Water Transport:

- **Canoes:** People hollowed out large logs of wood to make dug-out canoes. These were used for fishing and traveling on rivers, creeks, and lagoons.
- **Rafts:** Simple rafts were made by tying bamboo or logs together.

Trade Routes

There were well-known paths called trade routes that connected villages and even different regions. For example, the route from Kano (Nigeria) to Tripoli (Libya) was famous for the Trans-Saharan trade.

Then and Now

Transport in the Past	Transport Today
Walking, Head carrying	Cars, Buses, Motorcycles (Okada)
Canoes	Speedboats, Ferries, Large Ships
Donkeys/Horses	Trucks, Lorries, Trains
---	Airplanes



EVALUATION

- What was the most common way people traveled on land in the past? (Walking).
- Which animal was known as the “ship of the desert” and used in the north? (Camel).
- What do we call it when people carry loads on their heads? (Head Portage).

- What did people use to travel on rivers? (Canoes/Rafts).
- Which is faster for traveling from Lagos to Kano: a horse or an airplane? (Airplane).

ASSIGNMENT

- (Drawing): Draw a canoe on a river. You can add a person with a paddle in it.
- (Listing): List three animals that were used for transport in old Nigeria.
- (Comparison): Write one difference between how your father goes to work today and how his great-grandfather might have traveled to the farm. (e.g., “My dad uses a car, but his great-grandfather walked.”)



WEEK 11: REVISION

OBJECTIVES By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

- Recall key historical facts from the entire term.
- Answer questions on Early settlements, Empires, Trade, and Missionaries.

CONTENT Comprehensive Review

- **Ancient Life:** Nok, Ife, Benin civilizations and artifacts.
- **Great Kingdoms:** The Benin Kingdom (Oba, Bronze art), Oyo Empire (Alaafin, Cavalry), Northern Kingdoms (Hausa States, Kanem-Bornu).
- **Meeting the World:** Portuguese explorers, Trans-Atlantic Trade (goods and slavery).
- **New Ideas:** Missionaries (Mary Slessor, Ajayi Crowther), first schools.
- **Daily Life:** How people traveled (walking, canoes, animals).

EVALUATION

- Oral quiz and written revision exercises covering the term's work.

ASSIGNMENT

- Study your notes for the end-of-term examination.
-

PRIMARY 4 NIGERIAN HISTORY SCHEME OF WORK

THIRD TERM

Week	Topic	Content
1	Traditional Festivals I	New Yam Festival (Igbo); Durbar Festival (Northern Nigeria); Purpose and significance; How festivals bring people together
2	Traditional Festivals II	Argungu Fishing Festival; Osun-Osogbo Festival; Eyo Festival (Lagos); Unity through festivals
3	Traditional Arts and Crafts	Pottery and sculpture; Weaving and cloth making; Wood carving; Leather work; Preserving traditional skills
4	Traditional Marriage Systems	Marriage customs in different ethnic groups; Traditional engagement ceremonies; Respect for marriage; Family values
5	MIDTERM EXAMINATION	Assessment of topics covered in weeks 1-4
6	MIDTERM BREAK	Rest and relaxation period
7	Historical Features and Sites in Nigeria I	The Olumo Rock, Abeokuta; Ogbunike Caves, Anambra; Osun-Osogbo Sacred Grove; Importance of historical sites
8	Traditional Religion and Beliefs	Traditional religious practices; Shrines and sacred places; Festivals and rituals; Religious tolerance; Comparison with modern religions
9	Games and Recreation in Traditional Nigeria	Traditional games - Ayo, Ludo, wrestling; Children's games; Sports in different communities; Cultural values in games
10	Being a Good Nigerian Child	Respect for elders; Honesty and integrity; Hard work; Patriotism; Good behavior at home and school
11	REVISION	Review of all topics covered; Practice exercises; Question and answer sessions

12	EXAMINATION	End of term assessment
13	CLOSING	Report card distribution; Vacation assignment



PRIMARY 4 NIGERIAN HISTORY LESSON NOTES

THIRD TERM

WEEK 1: TRADITIONAL FESTIVALS I

OBJECTIVES By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

- Define traditional festivals.
- Describe the New Yam Festival and its significance to the Igbo people.
- Describe the Durbar Festival and its significance in Northern Nigeria.
- State two ways festivals bring people together.

CONTENT

What are Traditional Festivals?

Traditional festivals are special cultural celebrations held by a community to mark an important event, season, or religious belief. They are times of joy, dancing, feasting, and wearing beautiful clothes.

The New Yam Festival (Iri Ji or Iwa Ji)

- **Who:** Mainly celebrated by the Igbo people of South-Eastern Nigeria.
- **When:** Usually in August or September, at the beginning of the harvest season.
- **Why it is Important:** It is a thanksgiving festival. The people thank God (Chukwu) and their ancestors for a successful farming year and a good harvest of new yams. No one eats the new yam until the festival rituals are performed.
- **Activities:**
 - Rituals performed by the eldest man or chief.
 - Masquerade (Mmanwu) dances.
 - Eating pounded yam with delicious soup.
 - Wrestling matches, dancing, and merrymaking.

The Durbar Festival

- **Who:** Celebrated in Northern Nigerian cities like Kano, Katsina, and Zaria.
- **When:** During the Muslim festivals of Eid-el-Fitr (end of Ramadan) and Eid-el-Kabir.
- **Why it is Important:** It is a display of loyalty to the Emir and a show of military skill from the olden days when warriors used horses.
- **Activities:**
 - A grand parade of horsemen dressed in colorful robes and turbans.
 - The horsemen ride beautifully decorated horses.
 - They charge towards the Emir's palace and stop suddenly to salute him.
 - Drumming, dancing, and celebration.



How Festivals Promote Unity

- **Family Reunion:** People living in cities travel back to their hometowns to celebrate with their families.
- **Community Bonding:** Everyone works together to prepare for the festival.
- **Peace Making:** Quarrels are often settled before or during festivals.

- **Sharing Culture:** Visitors from other places come to watch, which promotes understanding and friendship.

EVALUATION

- What is a traditional festival? (A special cultural celebration).
- Which ethnic group celebrates the New Yam Festival?
- What important crop is celebrated during the New Yam Festival?
- In which part of Nigeria is the Durbar festival celebrated?
- What animal is central to the Durbar festival? (The Horse).

ASSIGNMENT

- (Drawing): Draw a big, fresh yam tuber.
 - (Oral Research): Ask your parents: “Is there a special festival celebrated in our hometown? What is it called?” Tell the class.
 - (Written): Why do the Igbo people celebrate the New Yam festival? (To give thanks for a good harvest).
-

WEEK 2: TRADITIONAL FESTIVALS II

OBJECTIVES By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

- Describe the Argungu Fishing Festival.
- Identify the location of the Osun-Osogbo Festival.
- Describe the Eyo Festival of Lagos.
- Explain how festivals promote unity.

CONTENT

Argungu Fishing Festival

- **Where:** Kebbi State, North-Western Nigeria.
- **Activity:** The main event is a fishing competition in the Matan Fada River. Thousands of fishermen jump into the water with only their hand nets and large gourds to catch the biggest fish. The use of modern fishing hooks or engines is forbidden.
- **History:** It started over 100 years ago as a way to celebrate peace between the Sokoto Caliphate and the Kebbi Kingdom.
- **Spectacle:** There is also canoe racing, diving, and cultural dances.

Osun-Osogbo Festival

- **Where:** Osogbo, Osun State (South-West).
- **Activity:** This is a religious festival for the river goddess, Osun. A virgin girl (the Arugba) carries a sacred calabash on her head from the palace to the Osun River, followed by priests, priestesses, and worshippers.
- **Significance:** To pray for peace, protection, and blessings for the town and its people. The Osun Sacred Grove is a UNESCO World Heritage Site.

Eyo Festival (The Adamu Orisha Play)

- **Where:** Lagos Island (Isale Eko), Lagos State.

- **Activity:** Eyo masquerades (believed to be spirits of the ancestors) parade through the streets. They are dressed head-to-toe in white robes and wear tall, decorated hats (“agogo” Eyo). They carry a staff (Opambata) and dance in a special way.
- **Significance:** It is usually held to honor a deceased Oba of Lagos or a highly important personality. It is a very solemn and colourful event.

Festival	Picture Icon	Place
Argungu		Kebbi State
Osun		Osun State
Eyo		Lagos State

Festivals as Tools for National Unity

When people travel from different parts of Nigeria to watch festivals like Argungu or Osun-Osogbo, they learn about other cultures. This understanding reduces fear and prejudice. It makes us appreciate our diversity and feel proud to be one Nigeria.

EVALUATION

- In which state is the Argungu Fishing Festival held?
- What do people compete to catch at the Argungu festival?
- What color are the robes of the Eyo masquerades?
- Where does the Eyo festival take place?
- Who carries the sacred calabash in the Osun-Osogbo festival? (The Arugba).

ASSIGNMENT

- (Drawing): Draw a fish jumping out of water.
 - (Research): What is the “Arugba” in the Osun festival? (The virgin girl who carries the calabash).
 - (Listing): List the names of the three festivals you learned about today.
-



WEEK 3: TRADITIONAL ARTS AND CRAFTS

OBJECTIVES By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

- Define arts and crafts.
- List three types of traditional crafts (Pottery, Weaving, Carving).
- Identify materials used for leather work and sculpture.
- State the importance of preserving traditional skills.

CONTENT

What are Arts and Crafts?

Arts and crafts are beautiful and useful objects made by hand using skills passed down through generations. They are part of our cultural identity.

Types of Nigerian Traditional Crafts

Craft	What is it?	Where it's Famous	Material Used
Pottery	Making pots, plates, bowls, water coolers.	Suleja (Niger), Ilorin (Kwara), Ushafa (Abuja).	Clay
Weaving	Making cloth, mats, baskets, hats.	Akwete (Abia) – cloth, Iseyin (Oyo) – Aso Oke.	Cotton thread, Raffia, Silk
Wood Carving	Carving masks, statues, doors, stools.	Benin, Awka (Anambra), Oyo.	Wood (Iroko, Mahogany)
Leather Work	Making bags, shoes, sandals, cushions.	Kano, Sokoto.	Animal Skin/Hide (goat, cow)
Sculpture	Making statues and figures.	Ife (Bronze), Nok (Terracotta), Benin (Bronze).	Bronze, Brass, Terracotta (clay)



Why We Must Preserve These Skills

- **Our Heritage:** They tell the story of who we are and where we come from.
- **Jobs and Income:** They provide work for many artisans and their families.
- **Tourism:** Tourists buy these crafts, which brings money to Nigeria.
- **Beauty:** They make our homes and lives more beautiful. We must encourage young people to learn these skills so they do not die out.

EVALUATION

- What natural material is used to make pottery? (Clay).
- Which city is famous for leather work like bags and shoes? (Kano).
- What do weavers produce? (Cloth, mats, baskets).
- Name one town in Nigeria known for bronze sculpture. (Ife or Benin).

- What is Aso-Oke? (A traditional woven cloth from the Yoruba).

ASSIGNMENT

- (Drawing): Draw a clay pot. You can add patterns around it.
- (Listing): List two items that can be made from leather.
- (Practical Observation): Look around your home. Do you have any traditional craft item (e.g., a carved stool, a woven basket, a decorated calabash)? If yes, tell the class what it is.



WEEK 4: TRADITIONAL MARRIAGE SYSTEMS

OBJECTIVES By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

- Define traditional marriage.
- Describe the marriage customs of one major ethnic group.
- Explain the importance of the “Bride Price” or “Dowry.”
- State why family values are important in marriage.

CONTENT

What is Traditional Marriage?

A traditional marriage is a ceremony where a man and a woman become husband and wife according to the customs and traditions of their ethnic group. It is not just about the couple; it is about uniting two families.

Common Steps in Traditional Marriage (Across Groups)

- **Introduction/“Knocking on the Door” (Ikoko/Iko n’ụlọ in Igbo):** The groom’s family visits the bride’s family to formally introduce their intention and ask for her hand in marriage.
- **Bride Price/Dowry (Idu Ụlọ/Ụmụnna in Igbo, Ẹbẹ in Yoruba, Sadaki in Hausa):** This is a token of appreciation and respect (not a purchase price) given by the groom’s family to the bride’s family. It can include money, kolanuts, drinks, clothes, and sometimes livestock.
- **Blessing and Festivities:** Elders pray for the couple, families exchange gifts, and there is eating, drinking, and dancing.

A Peek at Different Customs

- **Yoruba:** The groom and his friends prostrate (lie flat) to greet the bride’s parents. The bride’s family gives a list of items needed for the wedding.
- **Igbo:** The groom offers a cup of palm wine to the bride’s father. The bride is asked to identify her groom among his friends and serve him the wine.

- **Hausa:** The marriage is agreed upon by the families, and a dowry (Sadaki) is given. The wedding (Fatiha) is usually a quiet ceremony at the mosque, followed by a celebration.

Why Family and Values Matter

- Marriage is the foundation for raising children with good morals.
- It teaches responsibility, respect, and love.
- It strengthens the extended family network, which is a support system in Nigeria.

EVALUATION

- True or False: Traditional marriage involves only the man and woman. (False – it involves both families).
- In Yoruba tradition, how does the groom show respect to the bride's parents? (By prostrating).
- In an Igbo wedding, what does the bride give the groom to drink? (Palm wine).
- Name two items that can be part of a bride price.
- What is the Hausa word for dowry? (Sadaki).

ASSIGNMENT

- (Drawing): Draw a man and a woman in your tribe's traditional wedding attire.
 - (Oral History): Ask your parents to tell you one interesting thing that happened at their wedding or a wedding they attended. Share it with the class.
 - (Written): Why is marriage an important institution in society? (It creates families and teaches values).
-

WEEK 5: MID-TERM EXAMINATION

OBJECTIVES By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

- Attempt questions covering topics from Week 1 to Week 4.

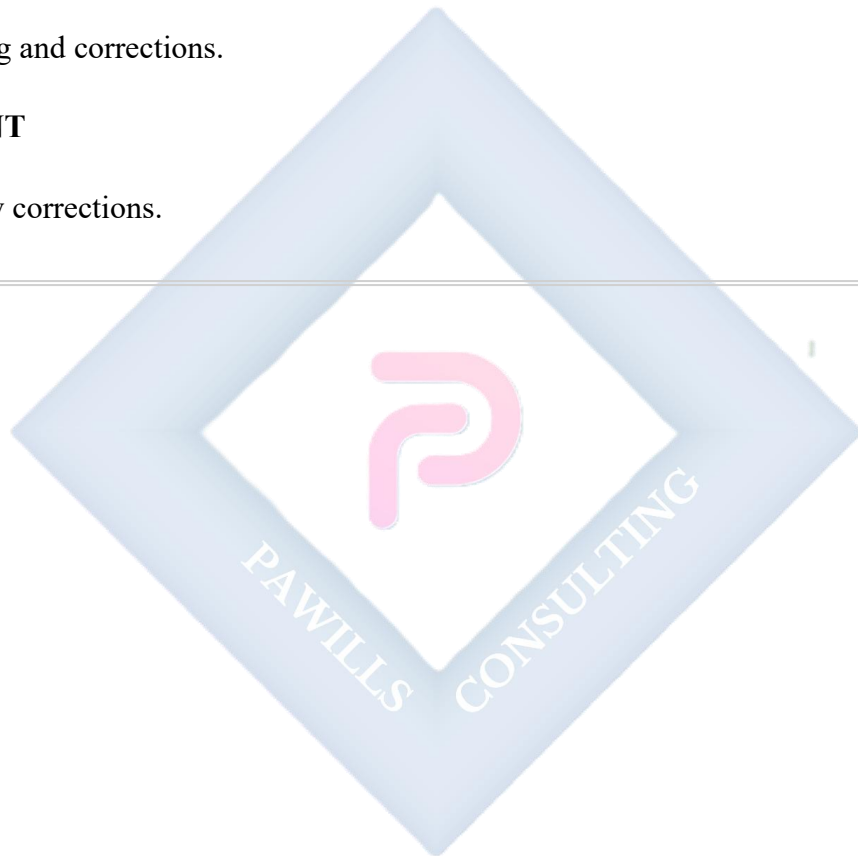
CONTENT Assessment: A written test covering Festivals (New Yam, Durbar, Argungu, Eyo), Arts and Crafts, and Marriage customs.

EVALUATION

- Grading and corrections.

ASSIGNMENT

- Review corrections.



WEEK 6: MID-TERM BREAK



WEEK 7: HISTORICAL FEATURES AND SITES IN NIGERIA I

OBJECTIVES By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

- Identify three major historical sites in Nigeria.
- Describe the Olumo Rock.
- Describe the Ogbunike Caves.
- State the importance of preserving historical sites.

CONTENT

What are Historical Sites?

Historical sites are physical places that have great importance to our history and culture. They are like open-air museums that we can visit to learn about the past.

Olumo Rock, Abeokuta

- **Location:** Abeokuta, Ogun State.
- **Meaning:** “Olumo” means “God moulded it” in the Egba language. “Abeokuta” means “Under the rock.”
- **History:** In the 19th century, the Egba people used the rock as a natural fortress during wars. They hid in its caves and on its summit to protect themselves from enemies. The rock provided safety and a good view to spot attackers.
- **Today:** It is a major tourist attraction. Visitors can climb the rock (with steps now) and see the ancient shrines and caves.

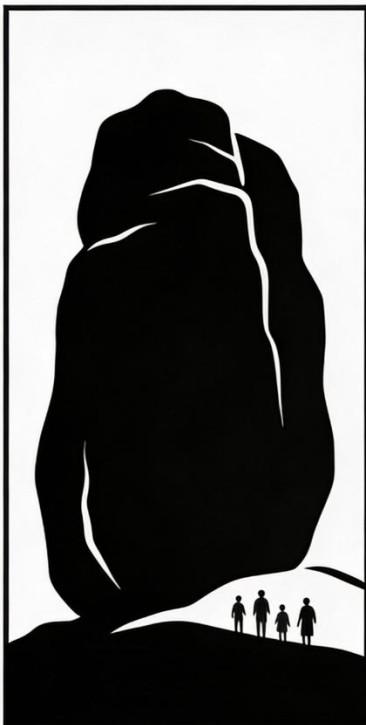
Ogbunike Caves

- **Location:** Ogbunike town, Anambra State.
- **Description:** It is a system of many caves and tunnels in a forest. A stream flows through part of it.
- **History:** The caves served as a refuge or hiding place for people during the slave trade era and inter-tribal wars.

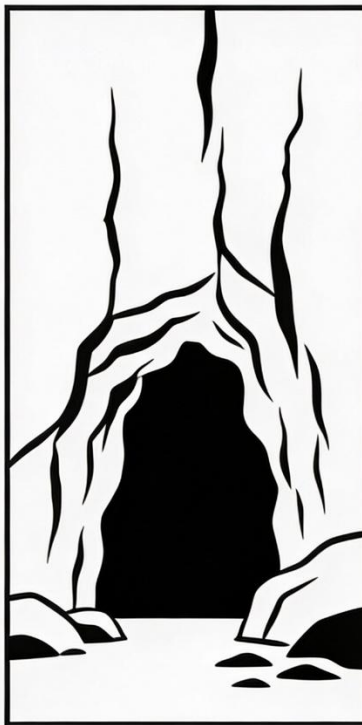
- **Cultural Rule:** Visitors are expected to remove their shoes before entering the main cave as a sign of respect to the ancestral spirits believed to dwell there.

Osun-Osogbo Sacred Grove

- **Location:** Osogbo, Osun State.
- **Description:** A thick forest along the Osun River, filled with shrines, sculptures, and artworks dedicated to the river goddess Osun.
- **Significance:** It is a UNESCO World Heritage Site, recognized worldwide for its cultural value. It is a living site where the annual Osun festival is held.



Olumo



Ogbunike



Osun Grove

Why Preservation is Key

We must protect these sites from destruction because:

- They are sources of historical knowledge.

- They attract tourists, creating jobs and income.
- They are a source of pride and identity for local communities and all Nigerians.

EVALUATION

- In which state is Olumo Rock located?
- What does the name “Abeokuta” mean?
- Where are the Ogbunike Caves found?
- Why did the Egba people find Olumo Rock useful? (As a hiding place during war).
- What must you do before entering the Ogbunike Caves? (Remove your shoes).

ASSIGNMENT

- (Drawing): Draw a big rock with a few small caves or holes in it to represent Olumo Rock.
 - (Research): Which state is the Osun-Osogbo Sacred Grove located in? (Osun State).
 - (Written): Give one reason why we should not litter or damage historical sites.
-

WEEK 8: TRADITIONAL RELIGION AND BELIEFS

OBJECTIVES By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

- Define traditional religion.
- Identify places of worship (Shrines).
- Mention the names of God in different languages.
- Explain religious tolerance.

CONTENT

What is Traditional Religion?

Before Christianity and Islam came to Nigeria, our ancestors had their own way of worshipping. They believed in a Supreme God (Creator) and also worshipped smaller gods/deities and ancestors who they believed could intercede for them.

Names of the Supreme God

Different ethnic groups have different names for God:

- **Yoruba:** Olodumare (the Almighty) or Olorun (Owner of Heaven).
- **Igbo:** Chukwu (the Great God) or Chi (personal god).
- **Hausa:** Ubangiji (the Supreme Being).

Places and Practices

- **Shrines:** These are sacred places, often in a forest, by a river, or in a special hut, where people go to pray and offer sacrifices (like kola nuts, palm wine, animals) to the gods or ancestors.
- **Priests and Priestesses:** Special people who serve at the shrines. They are called different names like Babalawo (Yoruba), Dibia (Igbo), or Boka (Hausa). They act as intermediaries between people and the spiritual world.
- **Ancestor Veneration:** Many believed that the spirits of dead grandparents and great ancestors watched over the living family. They would offer them food and drink to seek their protection and blessings.

Religious Tolerance in Nigeria

Today, Nigeria has three main religions: Christianity, Islam, and Traditional Religion.

Religious tolerance means:

- **Respecting** the right of others to practice their own faith.
- **Not fighting** or insulting people because of their religion.
- **Living together in peace** as neighbours and friends, regardless of our beliefs. A peaceful country is a prosperous country.

EVALUATION

- What do the Yoruba people call the Supreme God?
- What do the Igbo people call the Supreme God?
- Where do traditional worshippers go to pray and make offerings? (A shrine).
- Who is a Babalawo or Dibia? (A traditional priest/herbalist).
- Why is it important to tolerate people of other religions?

ASSIGNMENT

- (Oral Research): Ask your parents: “What is the name of God in our local language or dialect?” Write it down.
 - (Drawing): Draw a simple shrine – it could be a small hut under a tree with a symbol (like a white flag or a pot) in front.
 - (Written): Copy this sentence: “I will respect my friends whether they are Christians, Muslims, or traditional worshippers.”
-

WEEK 9: GAMES AND RECREATION IN TRADITIONAL NIGERIA

OBJECTIVES By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

- List three traditional games played in Nigeria.
- Describe how to play Ayo or Ludo.
- Explain the importance of wrestling in traditional society.
- State the values learned from games.

CONTENT

Fun in the Olden Days

Before television and video games, children and adults created their own fun with simple games that taught important skills and values.

Popular Traditional Games

- **Ayo Olopon (Mancala):** A strategic board game for two players. The board has 12 holes. Players sow and capture seeds. It teaches counting, strategy, and patience.
- **Wrestling (Ijakadi in Hausa, Mgba in Igbo):** This was more than a game; it was a sport of strength and courage. Strong young men wrestled in villages during festivals. The winner brought honour to his family and village.
- **Hide and Seek (Boju Boju in Yoruba):** One person (the seeker) closes their eyes and counts while others hide. The seeker then tries to find them.
- **Tug of War:** Two teams pull on opposite ends of a strong rope. It tests teamwork and collective strength.
- **Ten Ten (Skipping/Suwe):** A game played by drawing boxes on the ground and hopping on one leg to push a stone or beanbag through them.

How to Play Ayo (Simple Version)

- Each of the 12 holes starts with 4 seeds.
- Players take turns picking up seeds from one of their holes and “sowing” them one by one into the next holes.

- The goal is to capture your opponent's seeds according to specific rules.
- The player with the most seeds at the end wins.

Values Learned from Traditional Games

- **Honesty:** Not cheating when no one is watching.
- **Teamwork:** Working together in Tug of War.
- **Resilience:** Learning to lose without getting angry or giving up.
- **Critical Thinking:** Planning your moves in Ayo.

EVALUATION

- Mention two traditional Nigerian games.
- Which game is played on a board with seeds? (Ayo Olopon).
- Why was wrestling important in traditional communities? (To show strength and win honour).
- What does "Boju Boju" mean in English? (Hide and Seek).
- What value do you learn from playing Tug of War? (Teamwork).

ASSIGNMENT

- (Drawing): Draw an Ayo board (a rectangle with two rows of 6 circles each).
 - (Practical/Oral): Play a game of Ludo or Whot with your family or friends. Tell the class who won.
 - (Written): What is likely to happen if someone is caught cheating in a game? (They may not be trusted to play again).
-

WEEK 10: BEING A GOOD NIGERIAN CHILD

OBJECTIVES By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

- List four qualities of a good Nigerian child.
- Explain why respect for elders is important.
- Define patriotism.
- Describe good behavior at home and school.

CONTENT

Qualities of a Good Nigerian Child

To be a good child and future leader, you should have these qualities:

- **Respect:** In Nigerian culture, we show great respect to elders. We greet them properly (kneeling, curtsying, bowing, or using “Sir/Ma”). We do not call them by their first names.
- **Honesty:** Always telling the truth, even when you have done something wrong.
- **Hard Work:** Doing your schoolwork and home chores diligently, without being forced.
- **Obedience:** Listening to and following the instructions of parents, teachers, and guardians.
- **Kindness:** Helping others who are in need, sharing with your siblings and friends.

What is Patriotism?

Patriotism means love for and loyalty to one’s country – Nigeria. We show patriotism by:

- Singing the National Anthem and Pledge with pride and attention.
- Respecting our national symbols like the Flag, Coat of Arms, and Currency.
- Obeying the laws of the land.
- Keeping our environment clean and not destroying public property.

Good Behavior at Home and School

At HOME	At SCHOOL
Greeting parents in the morning.	Greeting teachers and mates.
Doing assigned chores (sweeping, washing plates).	Listening in class and not making noise.
Speaking politely to siblings.	Doing homework and assignments.
Eating together as a family.	Playing fairly with friends, not fighting.
Taking care of your belongings.	Taking care of school property (desks, books).

EVALUATION

- How can a child show respect to an elder in Nigeria?
- What does patriotism mean?
- Mention one way to be a good child at home.
- Is it patriotic to write on or break a school desk? (No).
- What should you do when you hear the National Anthem playing? (Stand at attention and sing or stay silent respectfully).

ASSIGNMENT

- (Written): Write the first stanza of the Nigerian National Anthem from memory (with help if needed).
- (Practical/Written): List three chores you promise to do at home this weekend.
- (Drawing): Draw the Nigerian Flag (Green – White – Green).

WEEK 11: REVISION

OBJECTIVES By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

- Recall key historical facts from the term.
- Answer questions on Festivals, Sites, Religion, and Values.

CONTENT Review:

- **Major Festivals** (New Yam, Durbar, Argungu, Eyo).
- **Traditional Arts** (Pottery, Weaving, etc.) and Marriage customs.
- **Historical Sites** (Olumo Rock, Ogbunike Caves).
- **Traditional Religion, Games, and Good Citizenship.**

EVALUATION

- Oral and written quiz covering the term's work.

ASSIGNMENT

- Study for the examination.